YU-CHENG (KANE) CHEN

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INTRODUCTION

I am a master's student in National Development at National Taiwan University. My research asks how the state governs through organizations at arm's length: why governments create administrative corporations and government-endowed foundations, how these bodies change over time, and why some of them become contested.

My current projects approach this question from theory and practice. An NSTC project compares institutional change across quasi-governmental organizations, while two commissioned studies show how such bodies are designed: a feasibility assessment for an occupational accident center and the personnel and pay systems of the National Institute of Traditional Chinese Medicine. I also work on energy security, and on how the Japanese and Korean legislatures discuss climate loss and damage.

My training is in public administration. Survey work at a public opinion research center, internships in city government and at an environmental law NGO, and two years on university councils taught me how policy is made, and measured, in practice.

EDUCATION

National Taiwan University *Sep 2025 – Present*
Master of Arts in National Development
Advisor: Prof. Tze-Luen Lin; Co-advisor: Prof. Kuo-Hui Chang

University of Taipei *Sep 2024 – Jun 2025*
Pre-graduate Student, Master of Public Administration Program, Department of Social and Public Affairs

National Chi Nan University *Aug 2024 – Jan 2025*
Exchange Student, International Politics

University of Taipei *Sep 2021 – Jun 2025*
Bachelor of Arts in Social and Public Affairs

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

National Taiwan University *Taipei, Taiwan*
Graduate Research Assistant to Prof. Tze-Luen Lin *Jan 2026 – Present*

- NSTC project, *Energy Security, Key Energy Resource Risks, and Regional Cooperation Strategies under Geopolitics*. Helping organize the project's second workshop, the Urban Energy Oasis tabletop exercise (TTX) set in Kaohsiung, and writing its participant handbook.
- NTUH–NTU joint study, *Exploring Parental Decision-Making and Ethical Issues in Prenatal and Neonatal Genetic Testing in the Next-Generation Sequencing Era* (from Feb 2026).

University of Taipei *Taipei, Taiwan*
Graduate Research Assistant to Assoc. Prof. Tien-Shen Li *Sep 2026 – Present*

- NSTC project, *Institutional Nodes and the Logic of Controversy Generation: A Comparative Analysis of Institutional Change in Quasi-Governmental Organizations, Focusing on Administrative Corporations and Government-Endowed Foundations* (from Oct 2026).
- Commissioned project, *Establishment of Personnel and Compensation Systems for the National Institute of Traditional Chinese Medicine*, an administrative corporation (from Oct 2026).

Taiwan Occupational Hygiene Association *Taipei, Taiwan*
Research Assistant *2026*

- Commissioned study, *Feasibility Assessment of Transforming the Center for Occupational Accident Prevention and Rehabilitation into an Administrative Corporation*. Wrote the chapter on comparator organizations in Japan and South Korea and prepared the focus-group presentation.

University of Taipei *Taipei, Taiwan*
Undergraduate Research Assistant *Sep 2023 – Jul 2024*

- Planning study on transforming the management system of Taipei City Hospital (Dec 2023 – Jul 2024).
- USR Hub project, *Urban Regeneration Master Plan: A Community Revitalization Experiment with Local Participation* (Sep – Dec 2023).

Telephone Interviewer, then Administrative Assistant and Supervisor, Public Opinion and Policy Research Center *Sep 2021 – Aug 2023*

- Supported surveys on pandemic relief measures (Ministry of Labor), public service satisfaction (National Health Insurance Administration), and knowledge transfer in AI decision-making.

RESEARCH

Work in Progress

- **Who Talks about "Loss and Damage" in Parliament? Climate Loss and Damage in the Japanese and Korean Legislatures**
  Planned submission to the 22nd TASPAA Annual Conference, 2027. Quantitative text analysis of parliamentary questions.

INTERNSHIPS

Department of Civil Affairs, Taipei City Government *Feb 2024 – Jun 2024*

- Surveyed convenience services at Taipei household registration offices and the emotional labor of front-line staff, with the Wenshan and Datong District offices as cases.

Environmental Jurists Association *Jul 2023 – Dec 2023*

- Studied how hillside development and building-control zones in Taipei evolved, and the links between hillside housing, urban renewal and the rebuilding of dangerous old buildings.

SERVICE

2022 – 2024	Student Representative, University Affairs Meeting and College of Humanities and Arts Meeting, University of Taipei
2022 – 2024	President (16th and 17th terms), Social and Public Affairs Student Association; Student Representative, Department Meeting
2022 – 2023	Member, Student Appeals Review Committee, University of Taipei
2022	Minister of Culture (9th term) and Chair of the Election and Recall Affairs Committee (8th term), University of Taipei Student Association

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

2023	Zhulinshan Guanyin Temple Scholarship
2022	Undergraduate Scholarship, Fall Semester, University of Taipei
Certificates	Survey and Research Analyst; Certificate of Completion, Center for Taiwan Academic Research Ethics Education

SKILLS

Methods	Comparative institutional analysis, cross-national case studies, survey research, quantitative text analysis, focus groups, tabletop exercise design
Languages	Mandarin Chinese (native), English (full professional), German (professional working)

REFERENCES

Prof. Tze-Luen Lin
Professor, Department of Political Science
Director, Center for Public Policy and Law
National Taiwan University

Prof. Kuo-Hui Chang
Professor and Director
Graduate Institute of National Development
National Taiwan University

Assoc. Prof. Tien-Shen Li
Associate Professor, Department of Public Affairs
Director, General Education Center
University of Taipei